

1964

was the year the first monochrome plasma video display was co-invented at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Now is the time to buy

The prices of LCD TVs have dropped by a factor of 35% to 40% over the year 2008.

TRIED & TESTED



Sharp Aquos LC-37A65M

gloss chrome that runs through the entire bottom bezel. This is what really sets off the entire appearance. If we awarded beauty the LC-37A65M would be our unanimous choice. The control buttons are on the top of the display — great points for ergonomics here.

Sadly upon testing we found that this beauty was only skin deep. There is an issue with red and this colour appears oversaturated and at times there are chromatic aberrations visible which centre around the red component. While watching movie clips even certain dark areas of the display had a reddish tinge. Text quality is good and text is crisp but for us the issue with the oversaturated reds was a little hard to swallow. The fact that this display has issues with other colours in Display Mate means that we cannot really recommend it unless it were dirt cheap. Which at a price of Rs 67,990 its quite frankly not and therefore loses out on our approval.

Onida Xaria Thunder 32-inch: Simply too mediocre

The Xaria Thunder is a very ordinary looking display. The outer bezel is glossy black while the inner bezel is a matte-finished, dark purple colour. The wide bezel is a bit of an annoyance and quite frankly we don't see the need on such small displays. The stand is also very mediocre and this display tilts forward even when its properly setup. Quality of fixtures of the stand and even the retaining screws is also mediocre. Since the outer bezel is slightly tapered it causes reflections on-screen which bespeaks volumes about design quality.

The HDMI connects on the rear jut out sideways and are very close to the back of the display; in fact we had trouble getting our slightly thicker reference HDMI cable. The slightly thicker plug would interfere with the body and we could not connect HDMI; and were thus forced to use D-Sub connectivity. VGA connectivity allows a plethora of resolutions and only 1080p and 1080i are not supported via D-Sub. Obviously since this display had a resolution of 1366 x 768

pixels we did not expect 1080p to work. The 32-inch Xaria Thunder has a lot of issues with the colour blue and any scene involving displaying of skies or water has a lot of artifacting and banding. Even greens are not displayed accurately, especially the higher intensity shades. Finally reds also have a slightly compressed look to them and colour tonality is way off — even after calibrating. With issues with colour it was obvious that this display is not ideally suited to movies and such, although to be honest most viewers will not be as discerning. One redeeming quality was this displays superlative performance with any sort of text — fonts are renditioned beautifully and everything looks crisp and sans artifacting. Priced at Rs 39,990 the Xaria Thunder is not really something that any serious



Onida Xaria Thunder 32-inch

movie buff should consider. Its good as a monitor however and its price makes it an attractive grab for someone looking at something that offers good value.

Videocon VDL-32-FBT: 32-inches of pain

This was the second display that Videocon sent us. The first one was another 32-inch model but after switching it on we discovered serious display anomalies that to us either meant that the display was not really worth testing or something was damaged internally. This display isn't really great to look at, but has a neat piano black



Videocon VDL-32-FBT

finish that we couldn't fault. The remote unit is quite good however and we liked the translucent buttons. In fact the remote works really well and there is no button lag as nearly all the other displays had. Upon testing we found that this display suffered from a deficient contrast ratio — it failed miserably in the grey-scale test and we could not even see the first 12 grade squares; which means if you not be able to make out darker colours from each other or from a black background — this is not acceptable for the movie-watching audience. The text tests were equally poor and at times the words were not even readable. At Rs. 37,990 even the pricing on this display is not attractive. Performance is not even mention-worthy. There are much better options available for the same price.

Panasonic TX32-LX80C: Less painful, on your eyes and pocket

Panasonic's 32-inch offering is an LCD display and quite frankly looks quite a bit like the 42-inch plasma display they sent us, only its smaller (obviously). Up front we didn't really like the remote unit because while it was feature rich buttons need to be pressed two or three times before the highlighted action occurs. There are no buttons on the display itself so you have to use the remote unit. Setting up this display was a task we did twice. The first time we used the ambient light sensor on the Spyder 3 Elite and got a very dim looking image and the whites looked a little warm. The second time round



Panasonic TX32-LX80C

we got a better picture but there was some moiré noticeable even when only the desktop was being displayed. Display Mate confirmed this and the greens were not as tonally accurate as we would like. 1080p content is viewable on this display but to be honest it is better watched on a display that can do the resolution of 1920 x 1080 pixels natively. That way any sort of scaling is not needed, and from the test it was evident that this display does not scale well with non-native resolutions. Text quality was much better than the Videocon display but nowhere near the Onida. At Rs 37,900 the TX32-LX80C is the cheapest display in test but it doesn't perform up to its price. As it stands we recommend giving it a wide berth. ■

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